NexaCore Technologies

Employee HR Policy Handbook

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Academic RAG Demonstration Document

This handbook is a fictional policy document created specifically for an academic Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) project. The company, rules, numbers, contacts, and procedures are synthetic and must not be treated as real employment or legal advice.

How to Use This Handbook

The handbook contains intentionally varied, detailed policy information so that a RAG system can answer direct questions, compare related policies, follow multi-step rules, and correctly respond when information is not present. Each section uses consistent policy terminology and contains specific values useful for retrieval evaluation.

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1. Employment and Probation

Purpose. This section defines employment categories, probation, confirmation, and employee records.

Employment categories. NexaCore uses four categories: permanent employees, fixed-term employees, interns, and contractors. Benefits and approval authority may differ by category.

Probation. A newly hired permanent employee serves a probation period of six months from the joining date. The manager may recommend confirmation, extension, or separation before the probation end date.

Probation extension. Probation may be extended once for up to three additional months when performance evidence is insufficient or mandatory onboarding requirements remain incomplete. HR must record the extension in the employee's HR record.

Confirmation. Confirmation requires completion of mandatory onboarding, satisfactory performance feedback, and manager approval. Completion of six months alone does not automatically constitute confirmation.

- Employees must keep their personal contact details, emergency contact, bank details, and address information current in the HR portal.
- Employment records must be accessed only by authorized employees with a legitimate business need.
- Interns and contractors are not automatically eligible for the same benefits as permanent employees.

2. Working Hours and Attendance

Standard schedule. The standard working schedule is Monday to Friday, 9:30 AM to 6:30 PM, with a one-hour lunch break. Individual teams may use approved schedules that differ from these hours.

Attendance recording. Employees must record start and end time through the company attendance portal. Remote employees use the same portal and select the approved work-location option.

Late arrival. An employee arriving more than 15 minutes after the scheduled start time should inform the manager before 10:00 AM. Repeated unexplained late arrivals may be reviewed by the manager and HR.

Overtime. Employees should not routinely work beyond scheduled hours without prior manager approval. Approved overtime is recorded separately from ordinary attendance.

Breaks. Employees should take reasonable meal and short rest breaks while ensuring team coverage and service requirements are maintained.

- Attendance corrections must be submitted within three working days of the incorrect record.
- Managers should review attendance exceptions fairly and consistently.
- Working from home does not remove the requirement to record attendance.

3. Leave and Time Off

Annual leave. Permanent employees receive 18 days of annual leave per calendar year. For employees joining during the year, the entitlement is prorated based on the remaining eligible period.

Sick leave. Employees receive 8 days of sick leave per calendar year. For an absence of more than two consecutive working days, HR may request supporting documentation where permitted by company procedure.

Personal leave. Employees receive 5 days of personal leave per calendar year for urgent personal matters. Personal leave should normally be requested before the absence.

Leave approval. Planned leave of up to two working days requires manager approval. Planned leave of more than two consecutive working days requires manager approval and HR notification through the HR portal.

Carry-forward. Up to 10 unused annual-leave days may be carried into the next calendar year. Sick leave and personal leave cannot be carried forward under this handbook.

Leave during probation. Employees on probation may request leave, but approval depends on team workload, project commitments, and manager approval. Probation does not automatically prohibit leave.

Emergency absence. When advance notice is not reasonably possible, the employee should notify the manager as soon as practical and update the HR portal after returning.

Leave Type	Annual Entitlement / Rule
Annual Leave	18 days; up to 10 unused days may carry forward
Sick Leave	8 days; no carry-forward
Personal Leave	5 days; no carry-forward
Probation	Leave may be requested; manager approval is required

4. Remote and Hybrid Work

Eligibility. Employees may be considered for remote or hybrid work when their role can be performed effectively away from the office, the employee has completed probation, and the manager approves the arrangement.

Hybrid schedule. The standard hybrid option allows up to two remote working days per week. Team-specific requirements may reduce this number.

Temporary remote work. An employee may request temporary remote work for a personal emergency or special project. Requests are normally limited to five working days per occurrence and require manager approval.

Availability. Employees working remotely must remain reachable during the team's core collaboration window of 11:00 AM to 4:00 PM, unless an approved exception exists.

Equipment. Company-issued laptops and accessories must be used according to information-security requirements. Employees are responsible for protecting company equipment from unauthorized access.

Workspace. Remote employees should maintain a reasonably secure and private work area and avoid discussing confidential company information in public places.

WFH is not leave. An approved remote-working day is treated as a working day and should not be entered as annual, sick, or personal leave.

Remote Work Type	Rule
Standard Hybrid	Up to 2 remote days per week, subject to manager approval
Temporary Remote	Up to 5 working days per occurrence, subject to approval
Core Collaboration	11:00 AM–4:00 PM availability
Probation	Standard remote-work eligibility begins after probation

5. Compensation and Payroll

Payroll date. Monthly salary is normally processed on the last working day of each month. If the last working day is a company holiday, payroll is processed on the preceding working day.

Payslips. Employees can access monthly payslips through the HR portal. Payroll questions should be raised with the Payroll Desk within 30 calendar days of the payslip date.

Salary changes. Salary revisions are based on approved compensation cycles, role changes, promotions, or other documented business decisions.

Bank details. Employees must update bank information through the designated HR process. Payroll will not accept informal bank-detail changes through chat messages.

Payroll deductions. Any applicable deductions are shown on the employee's payslip. Employees should contact HR or Payroll if they believe a deduction is incorrect.

- Salary information is confidential and should be handled according to company information-security rules.
- Employees should not share another employee's payslip or compensation details without authorization.

6. Travel and Expense Reimbursement

Business travel. Business travel must be approved before booking unless an emergency prevents prior approval.

Local travel. Employees may claim approved local transportation expenses incurred for company business when supported by valid receipts or approved digital records.

Accommodation. For approved domestic travel, employees should use company-preferred accommodation where available. Exceptions require manager approval.

Meals. Employees on approved overnight business travel may claim reasonable meal expenses up to the applicable company limit. Alcoholic beverages are not reimbursable.

Internet reimbursement. Employees on approved long-term remote arrangements may claim up to INR 800 per month for home internet costs when they submit the required proof.

Claim deadline. Expense claims should be submitted within 15 calendar days after returning from travel or incurring the expense.

Receipts. Claims above INR 1,000 require a receipt unless the Finance team has approved an exception.

Expense	Policy Rule
Home Internet	Up to INR 800/month for approved long-term remote arrangements
Receipt Threshold	Receipt required for claims above INR 1,000
Claim Deadline	Within 15 calendar days
Alcohol	Not reimbursable

7. Employee Benefits

Health insurance. Eligible permanent employees receive access to the company group health insurance plan subject to the insurer's terms and the company's enrollment process.

Dependent coverage. Eligible employees may enroll approved dependents during the annual enrollment window or after a qualifying life event.

Wellness allowance. Employees who have completed probation may claim up to INR 3,000 per financial year for approved wellness activities.

Internet benefit. The internet reimbursement described in the Travel and Expense section is available only to employees with an approved long-term remote arrangement; it is not a general cash allowance.

Learning benefit. Eligible permanent employees may request learning reimbursement under the Learning and Development policy.

- Benefits can have eligibility rules that differ from general employment rules.
- Insurance claims are governed by the insurer's terms and are not decided solely by HR.

8. Performance Management

Goal setting. Employees and managers should agree on role goals within 30 days of joining or the start of the annual performance cycle.

Quarterly check-ins. Managers conduct quarterly performance conversations covering progress, blockers, feedback, and development needs.

Annual review. The annual review considers achievement of goals, role responsibilities, collaboration, and demonstrated skills.

Performance Improvement Plan (PIP). When sustained performance concerns are documented, the manager and HR may create a PIP with measurable expectations, support actions, review dates, and a defined outcome period.

Promotion. Promotion decisions depend on role scope, sustained performance, demonstrated capability, business need, and approved organizational structure.

- Employees may request clarification of performance expectations from their manager.
- Performance feedback should be specific, respectful, and supported by observable work outcomes.

9. Learning and Development

Training. Mandatory compliance and security training must be completed by the assigned deadline.

Learning budget. Permanent employees who have completed probation may request up to INR 20,000 per financial year for approved external courses or certifications.

Approval process. The employee submits the course details, business relevance, cost, and expected completion date. Manager approval and HR/Learning approval are required before reimbursement.

Certification reimbursement. Reimbursement is normally processed after proof of payment and completion is submitted.

Internal learning. Employees are encouraged to use internal workshops, mentoring sessions, technical talks, and knowledge-sharing programs.

Learning Item	Rule
Annual Learning Budget	Up to INR 20,000 for eligible employees
Eligibility	Permanent employees after probation
Pre-approval	Manager + HR/Learning approval
Reimbursement	After proof of payment and completion

10. Information Security and Acceptable Use

Company accounts. Employees must use their assigned company account for company systems and must not share passwords or authentication codes.

Multi-factor authentication. MFA must be enabled for systems where the company requires it.

Confidential information. Internal documents, customer data, source code, employee records, and non-public business information must be protected from unauthorized disclosure.

Personal devices. Personal devices may access company systems only when the relevant security controls and approvals are in place.

Public networks. Employees should avoid accessing sensitive company systems from unsecured public networks. Approved security controls must be used when remote access is necessary.

AI tools. Employees must not paste confidential company information, personal employee data, customer secrets, source code, or credentials into public AI tools unless the tool and use case have been explicitly approved by the company.

Security incident. Suspected credential theft, malware, accidental data disclosure, or unauthorized access must be reported to the IT Security Desk immediately.

- Do not install unauthorized software on company-managed devices.
- Do not bypass security controls to access blocked systems or information.
- Lock your screen when leaving a company device unattended.

11. Code of Conduct and Conflicts of Interest

Professional conduct. Employees are expected to communicate respectfully and behave professionally with colleagues, customers, partners, and visitors.

Conflict of interest. Employees must disclose situations where personal interests could influence, or appear to influence, a company decision.

Gifts. Employees must not accept cash or cash-equivalent gifts from vendors or customers. Non-cash business courtesies should be modest and must not influence business decisions.

Outside employment. Employees must obtain written approval before taking outside employment or consulting work that could conflict with their role, working hours, or company interests.

Company property. Company assets, credentials, documents, and intellectual property must be used for authorized business purposes.

- Retaliation against an employee who raises a good-faith concern is prohibited under this fictional policy.
- Questions about conflicts should be raised with HR or the designated Ethics contact.

12. Grievance, Anti-Harassment and Workplace Concerns

Respectful workplace. NexaCore aims to maintain a workplace free from harassment, discrimination, intimidation, and retaliation.

Raising a concern. Employees may raise workplace concerns with their manager, HR, or the designated Ethics contact. A concern may be raised verbally or in writing.

Confidentiality. Information related to a complaint will be shared only with people who need it to assess or address the concern, subject to the requirements of the investigation.

Investigation. HR may conduct fact-finding interviews, review relevant records, and provide involved parties an opportunity to respond.

Emergency or safety concern. Immediate safety concerns should be escalated to local emergency services or the company's designated security channel as appropriate.

- Employees should preserve relevant messages, emails, or records when they believe those materials are relevant to a workplace complaint.
- False statements made deliberately to harm another person may be handled as a conduct issue.

13. Separation and Exit

Resignation. Employees who resign should submit written notice through the HR process and inform their manager.

Notice period. The standard notice period for permanent employees is 60 calendar days unless the employment agreement specifies otherwise.

Exit handover. Before the last working day, employees must complete knowledge transfer, return company property, and close or transfer assigned work items.

Access removal. System access may be disabled on or before the final working day based on security and business requirements.

Final settlement. Payroll and HR process final settlement after required exit records, asset return, and other clearance steps are completed.

Experience documents. Eligible employees may receive applicable separation and employment documents after the required exit process is completed.

- Employees must not retain company confidential files after separation.
- Company equipment must be returned in the condition required by the asset policy, subject to normal wear and tear.

14. Frequently Asked Policy Clarifications

Q: Can an employee on probation take leave?
A: Yes. Leave can be requested during probation, but approval depends on business requirements and manager approval.

Q: Is work from home the same as leave?
A: No. Approved work from home is a working day; leave is time away from work.

Q: How many annual-leave days can be carried forward?
A: Up to 10 unused annual-leave days can be carried into the next calendar year.

Q: What is the standard hybrid allowance?
A: Up to two remote working days per week, subject to manager approval and team requirements.

Q: How much home-internet reimbursement is available for approved long-term remote work?
A: Up to INR 800 per month.

Q: What is the learning budget?
A: Eligible permanent employees who have completed probation may request up to INR 20,000 per financial year for approved learning.

Q: When should an expense claim be submitted?
A: Within 15 calendar days after the travel or expense date.

Q: How long is the standard probation period?
A: Six months, with a possible one-time extension of up to three additional months.

Q: What is the standard notice period?
A: 60 calendar days unless the employee's employment agreement specifies otherwise.

Q: What should an employee do if confidential information is accidentally shared?
A: Report the incident immediately to the IT Security Desk and follow the incident-response instructions.

Document control: Fictional academic dataset, version 1.0. This document is intentionally self-contained for RAG experimentation. Policy values are synthetic and should not be used as real company policy or legal guidance.